

EXAMINED

Barco Clickshare

Even with devices like the Chromecast or platforms like Miracast, sharing the contents of your screen, be it a laptop or a smartphone, with a roomful of people is far from seamless for most people. In quite a lot of professional settings such as meeting rooms and conference halls, the only provision available for a presentation is an HDMI port. While it works perfectly fine, it comes with the constraint of being wired and requiring an HDMI compatible device on the other end. Barco Clickshare is a product that aims to solve the usual set of issues associated with presentations, especially in a corporate setting. We tested out the Barco Clickshare CSE-200 and found it useful but limiting.

The base unit needs to be connected to an HDMI compatible display with an HDMI cable and requires a dedicated power source. Once fired up, you are greeted by the default Clickshare homescreen with a few basic instructions on how to cast your content onto that display. The two included dongles have to be paired with the base unit by plugging them into the USB port before you can use them. Once that is done, simply plug them into any Windows or macOS device, run the Clickshare application from the detected drive and wait for the light around the dongle to stop flashing. At that point, pressing the button will cast the contents of your display and the accompanying sound



information onto the connected display. Similar functionality can be achieved on iOS with AirPlay screen mirroring, and on a dedicated app on both iOS and Android.

This is where the problems start. While the setup and usage on all platforms is fairly easy and user friendly, the performance of the screen sharing setup is not upto the mark. There's a significant degree of lag, and when sharing the screen from Android devices we experienced quite a lot of pixelation on screens with average activity that would take too long to resolve. However, keep in mind that this is intended for boardroom presentations where each slide stays for a while on the display. While it does satisfy that use case, for anything beyond that the Barco Clickshare CSE-200 is not recommendable.

PRICE: Available on request

GOQii Stride

The GOQii Stride is a small step tracker that you have to attach to your shoelace. The device is powered by a cell battery that lasts for 180 days, so once you replace the battery, you can stop worrying about charge for a good four months. This is perhaps the best feature about the fitness tracker. There is nothing wanting in terms of accuracy. When compared to wrist based fitness trackers, the numbers are similar. There is no need to repeatedly sync the device also, we have gone without a week of syncing, and the data shows up just fine. It is not clear exactly how long this tiny device can store data.

The biggest advantage and disadvantage of the stride is that it is attached to your shoe. While taking off the clip and putting it on another shoe does not take too long, you might forget to do it. It is good for tracking specific activities, for example if you run or trek with particular shoes.



The device connects seamlessly to both Android and iOS devices. You have to download the GOQii app, which comes with its own set of benefits, including the GOQii Life subscription that provides personalised coaching and a social network of fitness enthusiasts with similar goals. There is a three month subscription included in the box, after which you will have to pay to

continue. The app itself tracks the steps, shows the amount of calories burnt and provides a daily goal that it motivates you to reach. You can look back on your steps in breakdowns of months, days, hours and weeks. The amount of time you were active, or walking for is also displayed. Overall, this tiny device is very capable of doing one thing well – counting steps.

The Stride is a pretty hardy device, and the clip-on mechanism is strong. We experienced no issues with the step tracker even in crowded Mumbai locals, and on a couple of treks into the Sahyadris. According to GOQii, the stride is waterproof too. We have spotted this product at 50 percent off at some of the online stores, and at that price, it is definitely a steal.

PRICE: ₹1199/-